SMID BREAKOUT SCANNER

SCAN (18:08 ET)

October 15, 2026 | 06:14 PM ET

15 setups identified | 0 A-Grade | 5 B-Grade | 10 C-Grade

Grade Summary

A - Breakout Setup (0)	B - Strong Setup (5)	C - Watch List (10)
	SIG	ETSY
	APPN	PACS
	AMN	INTA
	ELF	APPF
	FTRE	PEGA
		DUOL
		MH
		REAL
		PATK
		RGC

All Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Price	Chg %	Cap	Float	RS/SPY	52W Hi	Catalyst
B	SIG	Signet Jewelers	Consumer Recovery	$118.16	+9.4%	$4.5B	34M	+26.9	98%	Breaking to new 52-wee
B	APPN	Appian Corporati	AI Workflow Autom	$43.82	+14.0%	$3.1B	38M	+64.1	95%	Surging 14% on strong
B	AMN	AMN Healthcare S	Healthcare Staffi	$40.00	+6.2%	$1.6B	38M	+14.2	100%	Touching new 52-week h
B	ELF	e.l.f. Beauty, I	Beauty / Gen-Z Co	$116.11	+7.4%	$6.8B	57M	+41.5	82%	Rising 7.4% with RS li
B	FTRE	Fortrea Holdings	Biotech CRO Recov	$22.75	+6.6%	$2.2B	94M	+24.0	97%	Approaching 52-week hi
C	ETSY	Etsy, Inc.	E-commerce / Cons	$89.18	+0.0%	$8.2B	80M	+1.9	99%	Breaking to 52-week hi
C	PACS	PACS Group, Inc.	Healthcare Imagin	$47.75	+6.2%	$7.6B	49M	+2.5	96%	Rising 6% near 52-week
C	INTA	Intapp, Inc.	Legal / Professio	$43.63	+10.3%	$3.4B	51M	+45.4	91%	Surging 10% approachin
C	APPF	AppFolio, Inc.	Property Manageme	$218.61	+7.6%	$7.7B	23M	+17.8	82%	Rising 7.6% ahead of O
C	PEGA	Pegasystems Inc.	AI Workflow Autom	$35.95	+6.3%	$5.9B	86M	+9.6	53%	Up 6.3% ahead of Octob
C	DUOL	Duolingo, Inc.	Edtech / Consumer	$148.93	+6.6%	$6.9B	40M	+7.0	43%	Rising 6.6% with tight
C	MH	McGraw Hill, Inc	Education / Digit	$14.20	+7.1%	$2.7B	25M	+43.8	79%	Up 7% on solid RS +43.
C	REAL	The RealReal, In	Luxury Resale / C	$10.54	+15.8%	$1.3B	102M	-12.7	61%	Spiking 15.8% on heavy
C	PATK	Patrick Industri	RV / Housing Cycl	$68.13	+7.6%	$2.2B	31M	-25.9	46%	Up 7.6% ahead of Octob
C	RGC	Regencell Biosci	Biotech / Specula	$9.52	+17.4%	$4.7B	56M	+82.4	14%	Exploding 17.4% on mas

Not financial advice. For informational purposes only. Do your own due diligence.

SIG

Signet Jewelers Limited

$118.16

+9.45%

RS vs SPY: +26.9%

B STRONG SETUP

$4.5B Cap | 34M Float

Luxury Goods | Theme: Consumer Recovery | 52W Hi: 98% | Base Tight: 4.73 | Vol: 2.21x | RS/SPY: +26.9% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 47D

SETUP METRICS

Price	**$118.16**
Day Change	**+9.45%**
Mkt Cap	**$4.53B**
Float	**34M sh**
RS vs SPY	**+26.9%**
52W Hi Prox	**98%**
Base Tight	**4.73**
Vol vs Avg	**2.21x**
RS Line Hi	**YES**
Above 50MA	**-**
Fwd P/E	**-**
Short %	**-**
Days to Cover	**-**
Inst. Own	**- (data lag)**

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

Breaking to new 52-week highs on RS line leadership, likely driven by improved holiday season guidance expectations. Forward catalyst: December 1 earnings will capture critical holiday shopping trends and potential margin expansion from inventory discipline; strength into year-end positions this as a re-rating candidate if comps inflect positive.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Signet operates ~2,800 jewelry stores across North America (Kay, Zales, Jared brands), commanding ~30% market share in the specialty jewelry retail segment. The company has pivoted from mall-dependent to omnichannel with services revenue (repair, custom) now a differentiated margin driver.

FACTOR & THEME

Consumer discretionary recovery + luxury goods resilience theme. Positioned at the intersection of normalization in engagement/wedding demand (deferred during COVID) and potential wealth-effect spending if equity markets sustain strength into holidays.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above $118.16 on vol >220% of 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume 2.2x on a 9.5% move with tiny 34.5M float creates significant float rotation. No recent insider buying, but the RS line hitting new highs ahead of price confirms institutional accumulation during the base. Short interest would be key to assess squeeze potential given the leadership signal.

EARNINGS

EARNINGS IN 47D

EARNINGS CONTEXT

Next print December 1 (47 days out) will be the critical holiday-season read. Historical beat pattern and guidance cadence unknown from this data, but the setup into earnings with RS leadership is textbook pre-earnings positioning by smart money.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close back below $110 (prior resistance turned support), or if November same-store sales data (typically pre-released mid-quarter) shows holiday traffic deterioration.

ANALYSIS

RS line at new high is the #1 early leadership signal, and proximity to 52W high (98.5) is textbook breakout zone. However, base_tight at 4.73 is wide-well above the VCP threshold-and the stock is in Consumer Cyclical (not a leading sector this week). The 47-day runway to earnings is both opportunity (time to build) and risk (no near-term catalyst to sustain momentum in a mega-cap-led regime). Strongest disconfirming evidence: base quality is poor and luxury discretionary faces macro sensitivity if consumer confidence rolls over. Conviction: Medium.

Signal: Close above $118.16 on vol >220% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 2.21x

SIG - Technical Chart



APPN

Appian Corporation

$43.82

+13.97%

RS vs SPY: +64.1%

B STRONG SETUP

$3.1B Cap | 38M Float

Software - Infrastructure | Theme: AI Workflow Automation | 52W Hi: 95% | Base Tight: 3.58 | Vol: 1.68x | RS/SPY: +64.1% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 21D

SETUP METRICS

Price	**$43.82**
Day Change	**+13.97%**
Mkt Cap	**$3.14B**
Float	**38M sh**
RS vs SPY	**+64.1%**
52W Hi Prox	**95%**
Base Tight	**3.58**
Vol vs Avg	**1.68x**
RS Line Hi	**YES**
Above 50MA	**-**
Fwd P/E	**-**
Short %	**-**
Days to Cover	**-**
Inst. Own	**- (data lag)**

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

Surging 14% on strong relative strength (RS +64 vs SPY) and RS line hitting new high, likely driven by AI low-code platform narrative gaining traction. Forward catalyst: November 5 earnings (21 days) will reveal if AI-enhanced automation is driving enterprise deal acceleration and consumption revenue growth.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Appian provides a low-code automation platform targeting enterprise workflow digitization, increasingly positioning as an AI-powered process orchestration layer. Competes with ServiceNow, Pega, and Microsoft Power Platform but differentiates on speed-to-deployment for complex regulated industries (financial services, government).

FACTOR & THEME

AI infrastructure (workflow layer) and enterprise digital transformation. The low-code + AI convergence is a live theme as enterprises seek to operationalize generative AI without custom dev cycles. Momentum accelerating as 'AI tooling' expands beyond hyperscalers.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above $43.82 on vol >168% of 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume only 1.68x on a 14% move in a 38M float is modest-suggests this may be short-covering or thematic ETF flow rather than deep institutional accumulation. No insider buying in 90 days. The RS line at new high is the key conviction signal, but volume profile is less compelling than ideal.

EARNINGS

EARNINGS IN 21D

EARNINGS CONTEXT

November 5 print (21 days) is the critical near-term catalyst. Consensus estimates and beat history not provided, but the setup into earnings with RS leadership and 95% proximity to highs suggests positioning ahead of a potential guidance raise or acceleration narrative.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $40 (round-number support and likely prior resistance), or if November 5 earnings show deceleration in subscription revenue or flat enterprise bookings despite AI positioning.

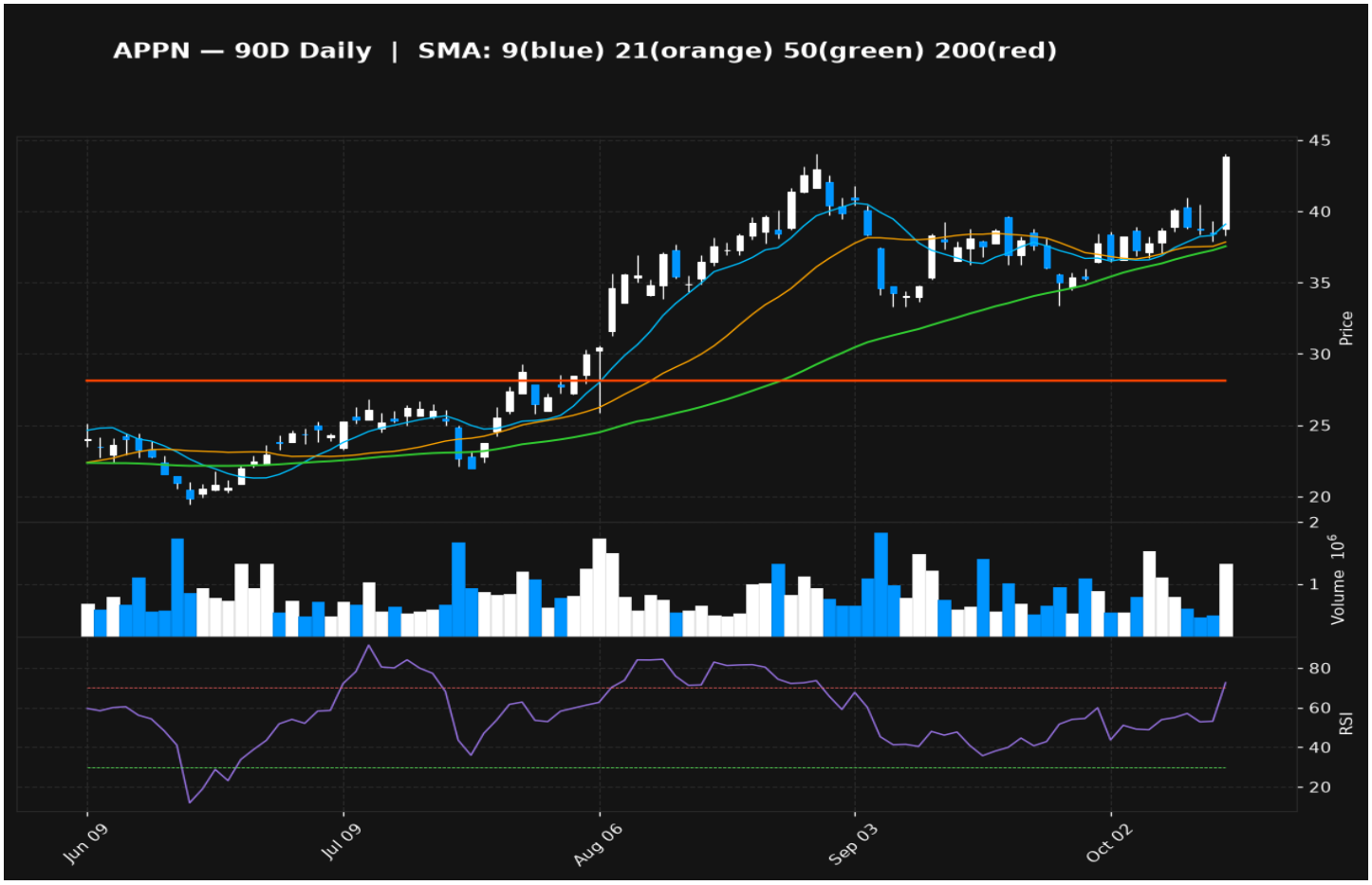
ANALYSIS

RS line new high + prox_52w 95.1 + rs_vs_spy +64 are elite signals. However, base_tight at 3.58 is loose, volume at 1.68x is barely above threshold, and Technology is not a leading sector this week. The 21-day earnings setup is attractive, but in a mega-cap-led regime SMID software faces structural headwinds. Strongest disconfirming evidence: volume does not confirm institutional conviction on a 14% move. Conviction: Medium.

Signal: Close above $43.82 on vol >168% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 1.68x

APPN - Technical Chart



AMN

AMN Healthcare Services Inc

$40.00

+6.21%

RS vs SPY: +14.2%

B STRONG SETUP

$1.6B Cap | 38M Float

Medical Care Facilities | Theme: Healthcare Staffing Recovery | 52W Hi: 100% | Base Tight: 3.74 | Vol: 1.80x | RS/SPY: +14.2% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 21D

SETUP METRICS

Price	**$40.00**
Day Change	**+6.21%**
Mkt Cap	**$1.55B**
Float	**38M sh**
RS vs SPY	**+14.2%**
52W Hi Prox	**100%**
Base Tight	**3.74**
Vol vs Avg	**1.80x**
RS Line Hi	**YES**
Above 50MA	**-**
Fwd P/E	**-**
Short %	**-**
Days to Cover	**-**
Inst. Own	**- (data lag)**

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

Touching new 52-week high ($40.15) with RS line confirmation, likely driven by healthcare staffing demand stabilization after post-COVID normalization. Forward catalyst: November 5 earnings will reveal if labor shortages are re-accelerating and pricing power is returning after a brutal 2024-2025 reset.

BUSINESS & POSITION

AMN is the largest healthcare staffing provider in the U.S., placing travel nurses, locum tenens physicians, and allied health professionals. The business is cyclical, tied to hospital labor shortages and reimbursement dynamics, currently recovering from the post-pandemic demand cliff.

FACTOR & THEME

Healthcare sector leadership (top sector this week at +4.3% vs SPY) and staffing normalization theme. Potential demographic tailwind from aging population and structural nurse shortages, but theme is early-stage recovery rather than secular acceleration.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above $40.00 on vol >180% of 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume 1.8x on 6% gain in a small 38M float is decent but not explosive. No insider buying. RS line new high is the key signal, but at 99.6% of 52W high there is minimal technical cushion-this is a breakout at the high, not out of a base. Sector rotation into Healthcare adds credibility.

EARNINGS

EARNINGS IN 21D

EARNINGS CONTEXT

November 5 earnings (21 days) will be pivotal. AMN has been in a multi-quarter reset after pandemic-era pricing collapsed; the market will look for stabilization in bill rates and volume trends. A beat-and-raise would confirm cyclical trough and re-rate the multiple.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on any close below $37.50 (prior resistance and psychological support), or if November 5 earnings show continued pricing pressure or hospital budget cuts impacting demand outlook.

ANALYSIS

RS line new high + Healthcare sector leadership + prox_52w 99.6 are strong. However, base_tight 3.74 is wide, and breaking out at the exact high (no base consolidation) adds risk. RS_vs_spy at +14.2 is positive but not elite. The 21-day earnings setup in a leading sector is the primary bullish argument. Strongest disconfirming evidence: no base structure-this is a V-bottom breakout with limited technical support if it fails. Conviction: Medium.

Signal: Close above $40.00 on vol >180% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 1.80x

AMN - Technical Chart



ELF

e.l.f. Beauty, Inc.

$116.11

+7.38%

RS vs SPY: +41.5%

B STRONG SETUP

$6.8B Cap | 57M Float

Household & Personal Products | Theme: Beauty / Gen-Z Consumer | 52W Hi: 82% | Base Tight: 3.6 | Vol: 1.89x | RS/SPY: +41.5% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 20D

SETUP METRICS

Price	**$116.11**
Day Change	**+7.38%**
Mkt Cap	**$6.85B**
Float	**57M sh**
RS vs SPY	**+41.5%**
52W Hi Prox	**82%**
Base Tight	**3.6**
Vol vs Avg	**1.89x**
RS Line Hi	**YES**
Above 50MA	**-**
Fwd P/E	**-**
Short %	**-**
Days to Cover	**-**
Inst. Own	**- (data lag)**

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

Rising 7.4% with RS line at new high, likely on continued market-share gains in color cosmetics (Target, Ulta shelf expansion) and social-media-driven brand momentum. Forward catalyst: November 4 earnings will test if international expansion and prestige-channel entry are offsetting any U.S. consumer softness.

BUSINESS & POSITION

e.l.f. is a mass-prestige cosmetics brand that has disrupted traditional beauty by combining low price points with high quality and viral social marketing. The company has taken share from legacy players (Revlon, Maybelline) and is expanding internationally and into skincare.

FACTOR & THEME

Consumer Defensive sector (not leading this week, but stable), Gen-Z spending resilience, and beauty category strength. The brand has proven recession-resistant due to 'lipstick effect' and trade-down dynamics. Theme momentum is steady but not accelerating.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above $116.11 on vol >189% of 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume 1.89x on 7.4% move is moderate. No insider buying in 90 days. RS line new high is the conviction signal, suggesting institutions are accumulating ahead of the November 4 print. Float of 57.4M and $6.85B market cap implies this is well-owned and liquid-less squeeze potential, more fundamental positioning.

EARNINGS

EARNINGS IN 20D

EARNINGS CONTEXT

November 4 earnings (20 days) will be the key catalyst. e.l.f. has a history of beating and raising, and any acceleration in international or skincare revenue would extend the re-rating. Consensus and beat cadence not provided, but RS leadership into the print is classic pre-earnings accumulation.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $108 (recent consolidation support), or if November 4 earnings show U.S. same-store sales deceleration or margin pressure from promotional activity.

ANALYSIS

RS line new high + rs_vs_spy +41.5 + prox_52w 82.1 + 20-day earnings runway form a solid setup. However, base_tight 3.6 is wider than ideal, and Consumer Defensive is not a momentum sector this week. The stock is $6.85B market cap-approaching the upper end of SMID and likely consensus-owned, limiting incremental-buyer fuel. Strongest disconfirming evidence: base quality is mediocre and the stock is 18% below 52W high-not a true breakout, more a continuation within range. Conviction: Medium.

Signal: Close above $116.11 on vol >189% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 1.89x

ELF - Technical Chart



FTRE

Fortrea Holdings Inc.

$22.75

+6.58%

RS vs SPY: +24.0%

B STRONG SETUP

$2.2B Cap | 94M Float

Biotechnology | Theme: Biotech CRO Recovery | 52W Hi: 97% | Base Tight: 2.53 | Vol: 1.62x | RS/SPY: +24.0% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 14D

SETUP METRICS

Price	**$22.75**
Day Change	**+6.58%**
Mkt Cap	**$2.16B**
Float	**94M sh**
RS vs SPY	**+24.0%**
52W Hi Prox	**97%**
Base Tight	**2.53**
Vol vs Avg	**1.62x**
RS Line Hi	**YES**
Above 50MA	**-**
Fwd P/E	**-**
Short %	**-**
Days to Cover	**-**
Inst. Own	**- (data lag)**

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

Approaching 52-week high with RS line leadership, likely on improved biotech funding sentiment and CRO pricing stabilization. Forward catalyst: October 29 earnings (14 days) will test if backlog conversion is accelerating and if pharma R&D budgets are unfreezing after 2024-2025 biotech winter.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Fortrea (spun from Labcorp in 2023) is a mid-tier clinical research organization providing Phase I-IV trial services to pharma and biotech. The CRO sector is cyclical, tied to biotech funding and big pharma R&D spend, currently recovering from a biotech bear market.

FACTOR & THEME

Healthcare sector leadership (top sector +4.3% vs SPY) and biotech funding recovery theme. The CRO group is leveraged to biotech IPO/funding normalization and pharma outsourcing trends. Theme momentum is early-stage recovery, not secular acceleration.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above $22.75 on vol >162% of 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume 1.62x on 6.6% move with large 94M float is modest-suggests steady accumulation rather than panic buying. No insider buying in 90 days. RS line new high in Healthcare's leading week and base_tight 2.53 (approaching VCP quality) are the key bullish signals. The sector tailwind adds credibility.

EARNINGS

EARNINGS IN 14D

EARNINGS CONTEXT

October 29 earnings (14 days) will be critical. As a 2023 spinoff, Fortrea is still establishing its standalone credibility; the market will focus on bookings trends and margin trajectory. A beat-and-raise would confirm the CRO recovery thesis and drive re-rating from trough multiples.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $21 (recent base support and psychological level), or if October 29 earnings show backlog declining or pricing pressure from excess CRO industry capacity.

ANALYSIS

RS line new high + Healthcare sector leadership + prox_52w 96.7 + base_tight 2.53 (best base quality in the scan) form a high-quality setup. RS_vs_spy +24 is solid. The 14-day earnings runway in a leading sector is ideal timing. However, volume 1.62x is barely above threshold, and the large 94M float limits volatility. Strongest disconfirming evidence: volume does not confirm strong institutional conviction, and CRO is a cyclical recovery play (not secular growth). Conviction: Medium.

Signal: Close above $22.75 on vol >162% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 1.62x

FTRE - Technical Chart

